An error occurred on this slide. Check the terminal for more information.

The Problem We're Solving

Knowledge is Dying

- • Great works sit unread in libraries
- • Historical context is lost
- • Personal connection to thinkers fades
- • Wisdom becomes inaccessible

Education is Failing

- • MOOCs: 5-15% completion rates
- • One-size-fits-all curriculum
- • No personal connection to teachers
- • Learners want dialogue, not video

"The unexamined life is not worth living." – Socrates

But how do we examine life when we can't truly converse with those who shaped our understanding?

The Vision

What if you could have a real conversation with Aristotle, Turing, or Marie Curie –
and they actually knew their life's work?

🧠

150+ AI Faculty Today, 10,000 Roadmap

Trained on complete corpora–every book, letter, speech. 1,000 per college × 10 colleges.

💬

Real Conversations

Not chatbots. Not search engines. Genuine dialogue with historical figures who know their work.

📚

20+ Live Products

Encyclopaedia, Bibliotech (76K texts), Singh lectures, Symposia, Homeschool, Apocalypso, and more.

What Your Support Enables

Immediate Impact

- ✓ **Faculty Development** – Train new AI personas on complete corpora
- ✓ **Bibliotech** – 76,000+ texts with faculty bookshelves and marginalia
- ✓ **Singh Lectures** – Interactive Khan/MIT OCW delivered by AI Faculty
- ✓ **Symposia** – 4 social formats: drinking party, Faculty Club, Salon, Debate
- ✓ **Homeschool** – Montessori/Waldorf lesson plans with verifiable credentials

Long-Term Legacy

- ✓ **Knowledge Preservation** – Complete works of great thinkers, accessible forever
- ✓ **Educational Innovation** – New model for inquiry-based learning; iNQspace open-source platform for institutions
- ✓ **Intellectual Community** – Global community of serious inquirers
- ✓ **Transparent Governance** – DAO structure with OpenCollective transparency
- ✓ **Named Positions** – Endowed chairs that carry your name or dedication

What We've Built

150+
AI Faculty Live
Scaling to 10,000 (10 Colleges)

76K
Bibliotech Texts
177 faculty bookshelves

13
Encyclopædia Volumes
483+ entries, 2 editions

20+
Live Products
Built solo in 4 months

Bibliotech
76K texts, faculty bookshelves, marginalia, AI reader

Singh Lectures
Interactive Khan/MIT OCW – interrupt, ask, debate

Symposia
4 formats: Symposium, Faculty Club, Salon, Debate

Apocalypso
Risk dashboard + companion book on catastrophic risks

Commonplace

Feed + News

iNQ Cards

The Inquirer

Platforms & Products

Your patronage funds the tools that make this possible

Atlas (compute platforms)

Purpose-built compute hardware for learning: DS (dual-screen), TriCorder (handheld), Classic (tablet), Sense (sensors), and the Inquiry Appliance – a $500 local AI server. Open firmware, privacy-first.

terrAIn (robotics)

An open robotics platform where RC construction vehicles learn to dig, grade, and haul on real terrain. A 4×8 ft bed of soil becomes a backyard robotics lab. Jetson + ROS2 + Isaac Sim.

Magisteria

Micro-credential courses with stackable certificates, skill verification, and employer-recognized badges. Free content for discovery; membership gates courses and credentials.

iNQ Cards ($20/mo subscription)

Physical learning card subscription – QR-linked card packs shipped monthly. Premium NFC, bamboo, and metal editions available. Scan a card, unlock the knowledge.

Atlas Compute Platforms & terrAIn Robotics

Atlas (compute platforms)

atlas.castalia.institute

- • **DS** – dual-screen clamshell (IPS + e-ink)
- • **TriCorder** – handheld field device with camera
- • **Classic** – 7" drop-tested tablet
- • **Inquiry Appliance** – $500 local AI server

Open firmware · No telemetry · iNQ Card compatible

terrAIn (robotics)

terrain.castalia.institute

- • RC construction vehicles on real soil
- • Excavator, dump truck, bulldozer, loader
- • Jetson Orin Nano + ROS2 + Isaac Sim
- • Home ($599-899) & Research ($2K-4K) tiers

Open source · ESP32 + micro-ROS · Backyard robotics lab

Your patronage funds **firmware development**, **open-source curriculum**, and **hardware kits for schools** that can't afford the upfront

The Castalia Credential & Virtual Campus

A living academy: structured credentials, a knowledge map, and an immersive campus your support brings to life.

Castalia Micro-Credential System

A modular, AI-native framework where students progress through micro-credentials (10–25 hrs each), earning scholarly titles inspired by medieval universities.

Apprentice → Adept → Magister → Fellow → Custodian

Each credential integrates AI tutoring (SAMWISE), AI grading (Beatrice), GitHub assignments, and portfolio artifacts. Students graduate not just with knowledge, but with **working AI systems** and a **PersonAI companion**.

Map of Inquiry & WorkAdventure Campus

The curriculum is represented as a **knowledge map**: cities are learning activities, regions are disciplines, and paths are prerequisite relationships.

Students explore this map through **WorkAdventure** – an immersive virtual campus where they walk the terrain of knowledge, encounter AI Faculty, and collaborate with fellow learners.

Your patronage funds the **Faculty who inhabit this world** – endowed chairs become permanent residents of the Map of Inquiry.

Specializations

AI Faculty Network

Institutional Legacy

iNQ Cards – Physical Artifacts of Knowledge

The knowledge is the product. The physical card is the artifact layer. **Inquiry before naming.**

QR Subscription Cards

Thick card stock, matte finish, line art + QR. 12 cards/month, domains spanning animals, plants, science, locations, and people.

Your patronage enables free packs for libraries and schools. **$20/mo**

Bamboo & Metal Artifacts

Laser-engraved bamboo cards and etched brass Magister medals – permanent artifacts that feel like Victorian scientific instruments.

Perfect for museums, libraries, and gifts. NFC tap or QR scan unlocks the same living knowledge.

Faculty Cards

Darwin, Hypatia, Euler – scanning unlocks an AI conversation with that Faculty persona

Expedition Cards

Yellowstone, Amazon, Moon – cards unlock maps and missions on the Atlas

Rare & Collectible

Golden Ratio, Principia Mathematica – special editions become cherished collectibles

Why This Matters Now

The Technology is Ready

LLM costs dropped **10x since 2023**. Real-time conversational AI is now economically viable. GPU advances enable multi-modal experiences (text + voice + avatar) that feel genuinely human.

The Opportunity is Unique

No one else is building **10,000 AI Faculty** (150+ live) trained on complete corpora. No one else combines real-time conversations with structured learning across engineering, science, music, and liberal arts.

The Need is Urgent

Traditional education is failing. Learners want **dialogue, not video**. Knowledge is being lost as great works become inaccessible. We need a new model for inquiry-based learning.

The Impact is Lasting

Your support doesn't just fund a startup. It **preserves knowledge**, creates a new educational model, and builds a community that will outlast us all.

Transparency & Governance

Complete Transparency

- ✓ **OpenCollective** – All funds publicly visible
- ✓ **Real-time Budget** – See exactly where money goes
- ✓ **Expense Reports** – Every transaction documented
- ✓ **Public Governance** – DAO structure with Council of Inquiry
- ✓ **No Hidden Costs** – What you see is what you get

Your Voice Matters

- ✓ **Named Positions** – Endowed chairs carry your name
- ✓ **Guiding Directives** – Shape Faculty agent behavior
- ✓ **Community Input** – Participate in governance
- ✓ **Direct Engagement** – Connect with Faculty you support
- ✓ **Recognition** – Featured in The Inquirer and annual reports

We're not asking you to trust us blindly. We're inviting you to see everything and shape the future alongside us.

The Castalia Ecosystem

Your donation flows through a purpose-built structure designed for transparency, impact, and longevity.

Castalia Foundation

castalia.foundation • 501(c)(3) non-profit

- • **Tax-deductible** donations
- • Endowed chairs & named positions
- • Grants for open-source educational tools (iNQspace)
- • Free tier, scholarships, library access

Your donations go here

Castalia Institute

castalia.institute • educational platform

- • 150+ AI Faculty (10K roadmap)
- • Bibliotech, Singh, Symposia, Encyclopaedia
- • Homeschool, Apocalypso, Commonplace, Feed
- • Magisteria, iNQ Cards, Map of Inquiry

Foundation funds this mission

Castalia Industries

castalia.industries • for-profit

- • Atlas compute platforms & Inquiry Appliance
- • terrAIn robotics kits (Home & Research)
- • iNQ Cards subscription & premium editions
- • Revenue reinvested into the ecosystem

Ways to Support

Endowed Chair

$10,000

One-time

Named position with guiding directives that shape Faculty behavior

Full Professor

$2,000

Per year

Support senior faculty leading research and teaching

Associate

$1,000

Per year

Support mid-career faculty advancing research

Research Fellow

$100

Per month

Support focused research projects

Every contribution, at every level, makes a difference. Your support directly enables Faculty development, course creation, and platform growth.

The Team

Daniel McShan, PhD

Founder / Custodian

- **PhD Computational Biosciences** (CU Med)
- **25+ years NASA**: Orion, Mars Phoenix, Stardust
- CTO Formul8.ai (AI/ML), VP Eng AVS (aerospace)
- 5 publications, 1 patent

Why This Matters to Me

After decades in aerospace and AI, I've seen how knowledge gets lost, how great ideas fade, and how education fails to connect learners with the thinkers who shaped our world. This is my life's work –preserving and extending the great conversations of history.

```
<div class="bg-slate-800/50 rounded-xl p-5">
  <h3 class="text-sm font-semibold mb-2 text-
  <p class="text-xs text-slate-400">
    Built the entire ecosystem — 20+ live proc
    hardware prototypes — solo using AI-augmen
  </p>
</div>
```

What Happens Next

Phase 1: Now

- • 20+ products live, 150+ Faculty
- • Bibliotech: 76K texts online
- • Singh, Symposia, Homeschool live
- • Seeking early patrons & endowed chairs

Phase 2: 6 Months

- • Scale to 1,000+ Faculty
- • iNQ Cards subscription launches
- • Magisteria credential program live
- • Community governance via OpenCollective

Phase 3: 12 Months

- • 5,000+ active learners
- • Atlas hardware prototypes ship
- • terrAIn robotics kits available
- • Self-sustaining through memberships

Your support today accelerates this timeline. Every contribution brings us closer to making the world's greatest thinkers accessible to everyone.

Transparent progress updates via OpenCollective. **Direct engagement** with the team. **Recognition** for your contribution.

An Invitation, Not a Request

We're not asking you to fund a startup.

We're inviting you to preserve knowledge.

To extend the great conversations of history.

To become part of something that will outlast us all.

"A society grows great when old men plant trees in whose shade they shall never sit."

We've built transparency into our DNA. We've shown you what we've built. Now we're inviting you to plant a tree that will grow for generations.

Join Us

Preserve knowledge. Extend conversations. Build legacy.

Become a Patron

castalia.institute/patronage

Explore the Platform

castalia.institute

Encyclopaedia · Bibliotech · Singh · Symposia · Apocalypso · iNQ Cards

Get in Touch

custodian@castalia.institute

Castalia Institute is building a new kind of intellectual institution—one that preserves and